which is why we needed the newspapers. We couldn't deal with it ourselves: we were talking about 90,000 Afghan war logs and 400,00 Iraq documents. Traditionally, we had analysed leaked documents ourselves and written the appropriate commentary with them, before feeding the whole thing to a single journalist or broadcaster. But this was different, and I spoke to the *Guardian*'s investigations guy about how to honour the material, and the source, and put together a package that would serve it and truly get it out there, as we'd promised. By that stage, I had already spoken to a reporter at the *New York Times* and was in contact with journalists at *Der Spiegel*.

I spoke to him for about six hours. He seemed professional and nervy and a little tired, but so did I, no doubt, and we seemed to agree on the importance of the documents and that it would be a smart move to involve the other news organisations. I wasn't grandiose about my participation, simply highly protective of the material, and experienced, for that matter, in dealing with these kinds of sources and this kind of surveillance. The later suggestion that I was simply a source myself was just ludicrous: I was the architect of the plan, and for the good reason that I was the only one of the group who knew how the material was stored and how it could be disseminated. I also planned the leak from beginning to end, so as protect it and enhance it, and, though it might offend the famous vanity of my erstwhile collaborators, they could take it or leave it. I wasn't asking them for money and I wasn't asking them for glory: WikiLeaks should be credited in order to advance its work, but they would have to go all-in with the plan to make it work, so readers could check the accuracy of the stories against the raw material. Of course, each partner behaved at the time as if this were a no-brainer. Only later, when they'd got what they wanted, would they unpick the relationship in such a way as to enlarge themselves and reduce us, an old-style government trick I should have seen coming.

The *Guardian*'s investigations reporter said he would speak to the paper's editor, Alan Rusbridger, who would speak, in turn, to Bill Keller, the editor of the *New York Times*. I then wrote a code on a napkin and passed it to the reporter in a bar. The idea was that he would be able to use this to gain access to an encrypted version of the material sent to him through an open channel. He now had the key and we set up a fake correspondence, saying something like 'It was nice to meet you but sorry the deal didn't work out.' This would throw any surveillance off the scent,